

Rubric for the Recommendation Report

Criteria	1. Excellent (A)	2. Very Strong (A-)	3.Strong (B+)	4. Good (B)	5. Generally Good (B-)	6. Above Ave (C+)	7. Satisfactory (C)	8. Developing (C-/D)	9. Below Expect
Content/Research Points: 85	The writer presents the report's content thoroughly and explicitly, giving the reader more than enough information to be usable. Sources are of exceptional quality, reflecting a thorough and thoughtful research process, and include an outstanding mix of both general and specific published resources.	The writer presents the report's content relatively thoroughly and explicitly, giving the reader enough information to be usable. Sources are of high quality, reflecting a very strong research process.	The writer covers the report's content adequately, and the content is generally usable. Generally, sources are of good quality.	The writer covers the report's content adequately, but in at least one instance, content could have been more complete or better supported. Generally, sources are of good quality and include an adequate mix of sources.	The writer covers the report's content adequately, but in at least one instance, content could have been more complete or better supported. Generally, sources are of average quality.	The report may be missing some important content that would increase usability, or needs more specific content in more than one area. Better mix of both higher-quality general and business-specific sources.	The report is missing some important content that would increase usability, or needs more specific content in more than one area. Much better mix of both higher-quality general and business-specific sources.	The report is missing enough important content to inhibit meaning significantly. The report needs more sources, or they need to be of much higher quality.	The report's content does not meet the minimum expectations for the assignment.
Format/Design Points: 45	The report is formatted correctly and relies on a model transparent design, with appropriate white space, heading structure, line spacing, highlighting and alignment.	The report is formatted correctly and relies on a strong, transparent design, with appropriate white space, heading structure, line spacing, highlighting and alignment.	Some minor formatting and design issues may be present in the report, but these don't inhibit overall reading/skimming.	Some minor formatting and design issues in the report, but these don't inhibit overall reading/skimming.	Some definite formatting and design issues may be present in the report, and some may inhibit overall reading/skimming.	The report shows some formatting and design issues; the inconsistencies in whitespace, paragraph length or other design issues will inhibit readability.	The report shows definite formatting and design issues; the inconsistencies in whitespace, paragraph length or other design issues will inhibit readability.	The report lacks proper formatting and any conventional sense of design— whitespace, margins, paragraph length— which significantly inhibits its readability.	The report needed significant help with presentation, and may not have followed the best principles of information design for these kind of research reports.
Writing/Style Points: 70	The report sounds professional, authentic, human, and controlled. The writer synthesizes research in a direct business voice with no personal opinion. The prose is readable and purposeful, free of generic business filler, fake polish, robotic phrasing, inflated language, source-summary stacking, and chatbot transitions. Sentence-level errors are rare and do not distract from meaning.	The report sounds professional and human throughout. Research is synthesized in a direct business style with no personal opinion. A few stiff, wordy, or mechanically rough moments may appear, but the writing still feels controlled by the writer rather than generated from a template. Bot-style phrasing is rare.	The report is readable, professional, and mostly direct. Research is mostly synthesized rather than dumped. Some passages may sound stiff, generic, or overly polished, but the writer still seems to understand and control the material. Bot-like phrasing is limited and does not shape whole sections.	The report is readable, but the voice is uneven. Some sections sound professional and direct, while others rely on generic phrasing, source-summary language, or padded business prose. The report sometimes sounds assembled instead of written by a person making choices about the research.	The report has recurring problems with wordiness, filler, stiffness, fake polish, or generic business language. The writing may be mechanically correct, but it often sounds like it is performing professionalism instead of communicating directly. This is the highest level available for repeated chatbot-style phrasing.	The report can be followed, but the language often gets in the way. Robotic phrasing, vague business language, weak synthesis, or padded source summary appears across multiple sections. The writer does not consistently sound in control of the research.	The report is readable in places, but style problems are frequent. Wordiness, repetition, vague phrasing, robotic language, and weak source integration regularly interfere with meaning. The report often sounds like source material has been rearranged rather than understood.	The report style seriously weakens readability. Sentences are often cluttered, repetitive, generic, artificial, or detached from the research. The voice does not sound human or professional enough for a business report.	The report language does not achieve its purpose for this audience. The writing is confusing, artificial, bloated, unreadable, or dominated by filler. Robotic phrasing, weak synthesis, and major readability problems prevent the report from functioning as professional communication.

Total Points: 200